India

India also played a role in the emerging economies' rise, owing to the geopolitical place it occupies in the convulsive Asian sub-continent. It is the great power in a region buffeted by a multitude of border disputes, separatist demands and local ambitions. The omnipresence of its army offset the tumult in Sri Lanka, tensions in Bangladesh, conflicts in Nepal, and a wave of Taliban-orchestrated terror. It has been shaped by the unresolved status of Kashmir, four wars with Pakistan, and border disputes with China after the military clash in 1962. There is also the unresolved status of Tibet.

The dominant classes manage a conglomeration of more than one billion people in 28 states and seven territories, speaking 18 official languages, and belonging to several religions and communities, all existing within a caste structure. The state structures are formally secular, but are crisscrossed by a multiplicity of sectarian clashes and by bloody explosions of communalism. This quagmire is habitually glossed over with a celebratory rhetoric which presents India as a stable and multi-cultural democracy.[12]

The biggest change in all this is the pro-US turn taken by the ruling classes who have adopted the neoliberal credo. The collapse of the USSR and the Pakistani military's prior support for the Taliban helped bring about this confluence of interest with the United States. The Yankees have increased investment in India from US$76 million to US$4 billion in less than twenty years. India already belonged to the secret global atomic club, but now it has the support of the Pentagon, which had previously supported its Pakistani rival.[13] Over the last decade, India's economy has recorded higher growth rates and gave birth to several multinational corporations with global status. It has also achieved a certain expansion in the technology sector, especially in software services. But its sub-contracting activities are carried out very far away from the epicentres of the digital revolution. Any comparison with patents or profit rates in the United States only confirms this gap.[14]

As with China, the resurgence of India has been accompanied by a millennial feeling of the rebirth of civilisations that occupied predominant global positions until the 18th century. But India's current growth is not comparable to its neighbour's. Industry continues to operate on a non-integrated, intermediate scale, highly dependent on external inputs and royalty payments. Productivity is low and infrastructure remains very obsolete. Social differences with China are even more pronounced. India has created the largest number of new millionaires and it has a large middle class. But 77% of the population remains in poverty and 40% are underweight. The fight against hunger has failed and 100 000 farmers